



PlayBook at ₹19,990

RIM has slashed the price of the PlayBook tablet by 18%. The announcement comes after the price cut of the iPad 2 <http://bit.ly/x0rzET>

HTC upgrades 16 devices to ICS

Some devices receiving the update are HTC Sensation, Sensation XE, Sensation XL, Desire S, Desire HD, Evo 3D, Incredible S, and Rhyme <http://bit.ly/xSkLam>

Olympus E-PM1 Review

Speedy micro 4/3rd option with point-n-shoot ease

This is the most compact in Olympus' Pen series of micro 4/3rd cameras. Aimed at point and shoot users, the E-PM1 is reasonably slim, compact and light for an interchangeable lens camera. The camera comes with the standard 14-42mm zoom lens as a kit, along with a detachable flash. The E-PM1 houses a 12MP 4/3-inch (17.3 x 13.0 mm) hi-Speed Live MOS sensor.

The big change with the E-PM1 is the fast 35-point AF system, claimed to be the world's fastest at the time of launch along with a faster image processor and 1080i video capture support. The back of the camera is dominated by the 3-inch 460K pixel 16:9 LCD screen along



with a revolving control dial that takes care of most of the shooting settings. The camera gives you a wide selection for 23 preset scene modes, to shoot in varied conditions without tinkering with any settings.

The large sensor of the E-PM1 takes detailed, noise-free shots upto ISO 1600, while ISO 3200 is usable for small size prints or web use. The excellent JPEG

engine produces punchy colors and manages to retain a lot of detail. Its kit lens is pretty sharp in the centre and offers good performance for its target audience. The AF system does live upto its claims in

most situations, locking focus almost instantly under adequate lighting conditions, though the performance does slide down by a couple of notches under low-light conditions. The overall image quality and performance of the Olympus E-PM1 is very good for a micro 4/3rd system camera, given its size, weight and the price-point in the market.

Sobam Raninga

Specifications

Sensor: 12MP Live MOS micro 4/3rd; **Lens:** Olympus M.Zuiko 14-42mm; **ISO support:** 200-12800; **Screen:** 3-inch 16:9 460K LCD; **Video:** 1080i@30 fps; **Other features:** RAW capture support, detachable flash included

Contact

Olympus Imaging India Pvt. Ltd
Phone: +91 22 6142 0400
Email: inquiry@olympus.in
Website: www.olympus-imaging.co.in
Price: ₹29,999

8.0/10

Features 8.0
 Performance 7.5
 Build Quality 7.5
 Value for Money 7.5

Specifications

Platform: Android 2.3.4;
Processor: Qualcomm Snapdragon MSM8255 @ 1GHz, Adreno 205, 512MB RAM; **Display:** 3.8-inch Ultra AMOLED, 480 x 800 pixels, Gorilla Glass; **Storage:** 1GB with microSD slot; **Camera:** 5MP with 720p videos; **Battery:** 1540 mAh

Contact

LG India
Phone: 1800-1809999
Web site: <http://www.lg.com/in/index.jsp>
Price: ₹19,000

7.0/10

Features 6.0
 Performance 7.5
 Build Quality 6.0
 Value for Money 7.0

LG Optimus Sol E-730

Bland but functional looks, consistent performance

Straightaway, we have to pick a fault. Nothing major – we think the Sol looks a bit bland. There are better looking smartphones in this price bracket – Motorola Defy+, Nokia Lumia 710 and the Samsung Omnia W. Powering the Optimus Sol is a 1 GHz Qualcomm Snapdragon MSM8255 processor and an Adreno 205 GPU, with 512MB RAM. This phone delivers consistently solid performance. The Optimus 2.0 UI doesn't have the HTC Sense's visual punch, but comes quite close with an impressive variety of widgets.

The 3.8-inch display is the Ultra AMOLED type. The brightness range of the display is excellent, so much so that it

can be uncomfortably bright if not adjusted. The on-screen keypad doesn't work well in portrait mode. While the key size could have been a little bigger, the larger problem lies with the surprising lack of precision. While you're certain that your finger is pressing the correct key, it's actually flirting with the neighbour! Things improve a bit in landscape mode, but even then, you can't type out an SMS quickly, without rechecking the spellings.



The 5MP camera is a pretty decent clicker, meant for the casual photographer only. Its lack of flash cripples utility.

While the phone has a 1540mAh battery, the backup time isn't very good – lasts about a day.

The Optimus Sol is a very competent mid-range

Android phone. The performance is consistent, with the only issue being a disappointing battery for heavy users.

Vishal Mathur